

Chapter 52: Confusion

Yan Lin's head felt heavy and dizzy, with sharp, dull pain coming from the back of her head and neck. The familiar beeping sounds in her ears were making her headache worse.

The noise was so bothersome that she frowned and struggled to open her eyes to see what was disturbing her sleep.

Yan Lin's eyelashes fluttered, then her eyes opened a crack, and all her senses began to work.

Cold white fluorescent lights came into view, and her nostrils were filled with the distinctive smell of hospital disinfectant.

Yan Lin felt unusually heavy all over. She could feel that she was even wearing an oxygen mask. At this moment, she could barely lift a finger, only managing to move it slightly.

Wasn't she at home eating dumplings with her parents? How did she suddenly end up in the hospital, and why did her neck hurt so much?

The ward was very quiet, so any movement from Yan Lin naturally couldn't escape Feng Yue's eyes.

After noticing Yan Lin's finger movement, she quickly moved to the bedside, leaning over to check on Yan Lin's condition.

Not long after opening her eyes, Yan Lin saw Feng Yue's familiar yet strange face appear in her line of sight.

Yan Lin was stunned for a moment. The shock of this instant made her eyes widen and quickly redden, and even her hands, which could barely move, were now struggling desperately, trying to reach out and grab the person in front of her.

"Yan Lin, you're awake. Do you feel uncomfortable anywhere?" Feng Yue asked while pressing the call button. Yan Lin's mother had left for a short while, so Feng Yue was the only one in the ward.

"Feng Yue... Ah Yue..." Yan Lin's voice was hoarse, and with the oxygen mask on, Feng Yue could barely make out what she was saying.

Seeing her red eyes and violent struggling, Feng Yue thought she might be uncomfortable somewhere, so she quickly bent down with her ear close to hear what she was saying.

"Feng Yue, am I dreaming..."

This time Feng Yue finally heard clearly. Knowing she wasn't uncomfortable anywhere, she felt relieved and answered, "You're not dreaming. We're in the hospital now. Wait, the doctor will be here soon."

As she spoke, Feng Yue wanted to straighten up and pour some water for Yan Lin, but she didn't expect Yan Lin to suddenly reach out and tightly grasp the collar of her shirt. She gripped it very tightly, so tight that Yan Lin's knuckles had turned white from the effort, like a drowning person desperately grabbing the last lifeline.

Feng Yue frowned. With the mentality of not arguing with a patient, she pried off Yan Lin's fingers. However, before leaving, she vaguely heard Yan Lin say something else.

"You didn't die, you didn't die. That's wonderful, that's wonderful... Let's go back to the country, let's go back together."

Feng Yue furrowed her brow tightly. She heard the words "die" and "go back to the country," but she didn't know if Yan Lin was talking nonsense.

She wanted to ask for clarification, but the medical staff pushed through the door at that moment. She had to give up.

A crowd of people poured in, and Feng Yue had to step back to let the doctor examine Yan Lin's specific condition.

At this time, Yan Lin's mother also came in. Seeing the medical staff entering the ward, she guessed her daughter had woken up.

"She's awake?"

Feng Yue nodded.

"Did she say she felt uncomfortable anywhere?" Yan Lin's mother asked.

"No, but she seemed a bit emotionally agitated." Feng Yue didn't understand what was wrong with her either.

"As long as she doesn't feel uncomfortable anywhere, that's good." Yan Lin's mother breathed a sigh of relief, then said gently to Feng Yue, "After the doctor finishes the examination and if there's nothing wrong, you should go home and rest. You probably didn't sleep well last night, and you came to the hospital so early this morning to help me."

As she spoke, Yan Lin's mother lovingly touched Feng Yue's pale cheek.

Feng Yue neither agreed nor refused. Yan Lin's mother was right - she hadn't slept much after returning home last night because every time she closed her eyes, her mind was filled with images of blood continuously flowing from Yan Lin's neck.

A tremendous sense of guilt and remorse surrounded her, making it impossible to break free.

Yesterday was too chaotic; she hadn't had time to tell Yan Lin's mother that Yan Lin was injured trying to save her.

Last night, Wen Zhen had also said that after checking the surveillance footage from the restaurant entrance, they would apologize to Yan Lin's parents together, and she shouldn't take all the responsibility on herself.

After all, it was the signboard from her restaurant entrance that hit Yan Lin. She should bear full responsibility.

Yan Lin was surrounded by a circle of doctors who blocked Feng Yue from view. Not being able to see Feng Yue made her anxious, and she kept murmuring Feng Yue's name.

The doctor removed Yan Lin's oxygen mask and gave her a careful examination before gradually dispersing, allowing the two family members to approach.

"The patient appears to be fine for now. We'll do a detailed examination later, and if there are no problems, she can be discharged once the injury heals."

Yan Lin's neck injury itself wasn't serious, nor had it damaged any arteries. The serious issue was her hemophilia condition.

So as long as they confirmed that the clotting factors in her body were working properly with the help of medication, she would be fine.

Both Yan Lin's mother and Feng Yue breathed a sigh of relief upon hearing this.

But Feng Yue thought for a moment and asked, "Doctor, when she woke up just now, she seemed a bit emotionally agitated. Is that okay too?"

The doctor looked at the medical chart and explained, "It should be mild memory and cognitive confusion caused by the concussion. It's only temporary - at most a month to recover, or possibly just a nap and it'll be fine. It won't affect daily life."

Feng Yue nodded, but felt puzzled. Would cognitive confusion cause someone to talk nonsense?

Even words like "death" and "returning to the country" appeared.

However, Feng Yue didn't question the doctor's professional judgment, just guessing it might also be an aftereffect of the concussion.

After seeing off the doctor, the ward became quiet again, and the sound of Yan Lin calling Feng Yue's name became clear again.

During the entire examination, Yan Lin's mind had been foggy, and she hadn't heard what they specifically said. Now her only thought was to see if she was really dreaming, to know if her wife really hadn't died.

However, Yan Lin's body, weakened from blood loss, couldn't support her doing much. Her eyelids grew increasingly heavy, and her body told her she needed to sleep well again.

But her longing for Feng Yue made her reach out and firmly grasp Feng Yue's fingers hanging at her side. Only after feeling that she had grasped the other person did she fall into a deep sleep.

Feng Yue, standing by the bed, was suddenly grabbed by the fingers. She instinctively wanted to break free, but it was useless.

Yan Lin in her sleep seemed to sense Feng Yue's resistance, murmured a few words, and gripped even tighter.

"This..." Yan Lin's mother watched this scene, feeling quite embarrassed. "It's okay, I'll help you pry open Ah Lin's fingers."

Feng Yue just felt her forehead throbbing with pain and said, "Let's wait until she's completely asleep."

Yan Lin's mother nodded and pulled over a chair for Feng Yue to sit down and rest.

Only when Yan Lin was completely asleep did Feng Yue rescue her hand from the other person's grip.

As soon as she got her hand free, her phone rang in her pocket.

Feng Yue glanced at it - it was a call from Wen Zhen.

Feng Yue gestured to Yan Lin's mother that she was going to the reception room outside to take the call, then pressed the answer key.

"Hello, Sister Wen Zhen."

Wen Zhen's voice also sounded extremely tired. "Ah Yue, I'm already on my way to the hospital. I'll be there in five minutes. I've also obtained the surveillance footage."

Feng Yue was silent for a while, then nodded. "Okay, I'll wait for you in the ward."

This was their fault, and they should explain clearly to Yan Lin's mother.

Five minutes later, Wen Zhen knocked on the ward door right on time. When Feng Yue opened the door, she saw a travel-worn Wen Zhen.

The other person also looked haggard, clearly having not slept well all night.

"Auntie is inside. I'll go call her."

Wen Zhen nodded, then took out her laptop from her bag and placed it on the table in the reception room.

Yan Lin's mother looked at the two with some confusion. She didn't know Wen Zhen, but could guess that she was probably a friend of Feng Yue and Yan Lin.

"Xiao Yue, what's going on?"

"Auntie, Miss Yan was injured at the entrance of my restaurant last night, and that signboard was also from my restaurant."

Upon hearing this, Yan Lin's mother's face darkened. She hadn't had time to investigate this matter yet, but that didn't mean she wouldn't pursue it.

In her eyes, Yan Lin's health was more important than pursuing this matter, so she had originally planned to settle accounts later and investigate properly then.

"I will compensate for all of Miss Yan's losses and medical expenses. Feng Yue and I are friends, and you are her close elder, so I felt this matter should be confessed to you."

"What exactly happened at the time?" Yan Lin's mother asked in a heavy voice.

Wen Zhen didn't say much, just clicked on the surveillance video saved on her computer.

First to appear in the video was Feng Yue, walking quickly as if she had something urgent to do. Then Yan Lin, chasing behind, also appeared in the video.

Then, in an instant too quick to react to, Yan Lin suddenly started running, threw herself at Feng Yue, then quickly turned right, protecting Feng Yue entirely in her arms, using her own back to face the falling signboard.

The side of the signboard with the fabric banner hit the back of Yan Lin's head, then the sharp corner cut through her neck. As for her back, it escaped disaster because of the thick winter clothes.

The video was only thirty seconds long, stopping after it finished playing.

The reception room was very quiet, so quiet that Feng Yue could hear her own heartbeat.

After a while, Yan Lin's mother sighed, but before she could say anything, Feng Yue spoke first: "Auntie, I'm sorry. Yan Lin was injured trying to save me. She clearly—"

"Xiao Yue," Before Feng Yue could finish, Yan Lin's mother seriously interrupted her, "Ah Lin chose to save you herself. You don't need to apologize."

Yan Lin's mother's expression was serious. She wasn't just being polite; she genuinely felt this way.

"Ah Lin is very aware of her own physical condition. I don't know if her decision to save you in that moment was the result of careful consideration or an instinctive reaction, but whatever it was, it was a decision she made personally. In that moment, she felt that your safety was more important than her own."

"And as her mother, I can't make things difficult for you because of the decision she made. You didn't do anything wrong." The latter half of Yan Lin's mother's words were gentle in tone and warm in manner. As she spoke, she reached out and held Feng Yue's hands, which were wringing together from anxiety.

Speaking of which, Yan Lin's mother also turned to look at Wen Zhen and sighed softly, "I saw that 'Beware of Falling Objects' sign in the surveillance footage. I can only say this was indeed a distressing accident. Even if it hadn't hit Ah Lin, it would have hit someone else."

Wen Zhen lowered her eyelashes. "That signboard was originally supposed to be replaced last night, but the worker replacing it had to take an hour off for an emergency. The restaurant staff put up a warning sign there to remind everyone, but an accident still happened."

Yan Lin's mother rubbed her forehead and said, "Indeed, very unlucky. It looks like we'll have to go to the temple to burn incense during New Year."

"However, you should still bear the responsibility you should bear. As you said, you'll cover the medical expenses and such."

Wen Zhen knew that Yan Lin's mother was giving her a way out, so she nodded. "Auntie, I'm truly sorry."

"Auntie, no matter how you look at it, this happened because of me. I'll help you take care of Yan Lin until she recovers and is discharged from the hospital." Feng Yue said.

She indeed disliked Yan Lin, but she hadn't reached the point of being ungrateful. She also didn't want to owe Yan Lin anything, so this period of care would repay this debt.

"Good, then I'll trouble you."

The matter was resolved this way. Feng Yue and Yan Lin's mother stayed in the ward to take care of Yan Lin, while Wen Zhen left the hospital alone.

After lunch, Yan Lin's mother sat on the sofa reading a book, and Feng Yue went to the restroom.

Yan Lin groggily opened her eyes, and the pain from her neck made her groan involuntarily.

Yan Lin's mother quickly stepped forward, looking at Yan Lin with concern.

Yan Lin's mind was much clearer, and when she saw Yan Lin's mother, she recognized her. "Mom..."

"Ah! Ah Lin, how do you feel? Do you feel uncomfortable anywhere?" As she spoke, Yan Lin's mother put a drinking straw to her mouth. "Don't talk yet, drink some water to moisten your throat first."

After drinking water, Yan Lin could speak more smoothly. She had many questions: "Mom, are we in a German hospital? Didn't Feng Yue die? I saw her, I definitely saw her before!"

Yan Lin became more and more excited as she spoke, even reaching out to grab Yan Lin's mother's wrist.

Seeing her talking nonsense, Yan Lin's mother frowned. "How could Xiao Yue die? What nonsense are you talking about? This is a ward at Beijing First People's Hospital¹, not Germany."

Yan Lin wanted to ask more, but suddenly felt a burning gaze fall on her.

She turned her head and saw Feng Yue standing at the door.

Feng Yue stood there blankly, staring at Yan Lin with disbelief.

Germany, death, returning to the country...

These seemingly unrelated words gradually formed a huge, unbelievable speculation in Feng Yue's mind.

Yan Lin, perhaps like her, was also...

Author's Note:

La la la la la, the secret's out! Currently revealed but not completely - Moon thinks that the previous life's Yan Lin only transmigrated at this time.

And I noticed everyone is quite sensitive about this amnesia thing hahaha. There won't be amnesia! If a mild concussion caused amnesia, that would be too ridiculous (although it's already quite ridiculous now). The reason for designing the mild concussion is to strip away Old Yan's disguise. Her confused memories now make her like she was when she just transmigrated back, but it's not permanent. After her concussion recovers, her memory will be completely fine.

The two people still need to be honest with each other.

I need to mention again here that all the medical aspects in the text are fabricated or referenced from Baidu Encyclopedia. Please don't scrutinize them too closely (bows).

Footnotes:

¹ **Beijing First People's Hospital (燕京第一人民医院)** - Since "Yan Jing" is used as the fictional name for Beijing in this story, this would be the equivalent of Beijing's top public hospital